



3-Minute Bible Discussion Guide

Praying When God Feels Far Away

OPENING PRAYER

Faithful God, you know each of our hearts, our hopes, and our questions. As we turn to Scripture together, open our ears to hear words that teach us about our faith. Give us courage to listen, humility to learn, and the capacity for grace as we engage with one another. In the name of your Son Jesus Christ we pray. *Amen.*

SCRIPTURE READING

Psalm 13 – [LINK HERE](#)

(Read aloud as a group.)

WATCH VIDEO

3-Minute Bible (*Understanding Psalms of Lament*) – [LINK HERE](#)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. The video points out that many psalms of lament follow a pattern of complaint, petitions for God's help, a rationale, and praise. As you read Psalm 13, where do you notice this pattern? Which parts are most prominent?
 2. What does the psalmist seem to be lamenting? What is the psalmist's petition to God, and what reasons are given for why God should act?
 3. In what ways does the psalmist communicate trust in God's power to intervene? How do these expressions of trust reflect the psalmist's own steadfast faith in God? Are prayers of lament ultimately expressions of hope?
 4. Are prayers of lament a regular part of your church community's worship or congregational life? If so, how? If not, why do you think this is the case?
 5. In what ways have you ever felt reluctant to express anger and frustration to God, either in public or in private prayers?
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CLOSING PRAYER

Gracious God, we give thanks for the gift of honest and faithful prayer. When we feel forgotten or overwhelmed, help us remember that we can express our feelings to you, knowing that lament is a reflection of our faithfulness.

Give us courage to express our grief and longing to you, and boldly ask for your help, remembering that you are an ever-faithful God. In the name of your Son Jesus Christ we pray. *Amen.*
